

JUNIOR CLOUD SECURITY ENGINEER ARSENAL

Candidate: Chad K. Bachoo | **Methodology:** STAR Interview Framework | **Target:** Core Governance & Incident Triage

Story 1: Automated Security Process Engineering (AWS Config Drift)

Interview Question: "Tell me about a time you had to automate a security process."

■■ Delivery Window: 60-90 Seconds Oral Cadence

SITUATION	During our automated infrastructure engineering cycle, our rapid pipeline deployments were causing critical security configuration drift. We discovered that manual parameter definitions frequently introduced exposed storage nodes and missing compliance hooks, creating significant data exposure liabilities across multi-tenant sandbox testing partitions.
TASK	I was tasked with implementing a reliable continuous compliance and automated governance framework for Titan FinTech. The mandate was to ensure zero data perimeter leaks by programmatically identifying configuration drift and enforcing strict operational data blocks without adding deployment friction.
ACTION	I codified an enterprise-wide monitoring pipeline using Terraform to deploy an automated AWS Config Recorder engine. I patched template rule target constraints, mapping them precisely to the official AWS managed directive string: S3_BUCKET_PUBLIC_READ_PROHIBITED. I then intentionally simulated a developer misconfiguration drift by launching an unhardened, open-access public S3 bucket to validate visibility triggers and alarm thresholds.
RESULT	The automated AWS Config monitoring rule successfully caught the structural drift within 120 seconds, flagging the bucket with a definitive red Noncompliant badge on the centralized security monitoring dashboard. By translating raw technical configurations directly into immediate executive business risk context, I secured unanimous leadership budget approval for our DevSecOps automated remediation pipeline. This shifted our security left and fully neutralized perimeter exposure vectors before production delivery.

Story 2: Forensic Troubleshooting & Critical Incident Response

Interview Question: "Tell me about a time you had to troubleshoot a massive failure or contain an active breach."

■■ Delivery Window: 60-90 Seconds Oral Cadence

SITUATION	During a fast-paced incident response and containment exercise, we simulated a live security breach where an enterprise-tier production EC2 host instance was actively compromised by an adversary via an unrestricted administrative ingress port boundary.
TASK	I was tasked with executing emergency incident response isolation protocols to completely contain the malicious lateral threat pivot across our cloud infrastructure, while carefully preserving volatile forensic tracking data residues within the active server RAM registers for advanced post-mortem triage.

ACTION

Instead of abruptly terminating the server and wiping out critical forensic proof, I programmatically isolated the machine from the network topology by swapping its security group out for a custom-engineered 'IR-Total-Lockdown' group containing zero inbound and zero outbound rules. Simultaneously, I codified and applied an emergency Identity and Access Management (IAM) explicit root wildcard deny instruction policy manifest to instantly freeze the capabilities of the hijacked credentials across the global account perimeter.

RESULT

The adversary's stolen API authentication keys were immediately neutralized, completely stopping further privilege escalation and preventing lateral host hopping. By maintaining complete structural uptime of the isolated machine, all volatile execution logs in memory remained 100% intact. This provided our forensic team with the vital audit evidence needed to unmask the attacker's origin, preserving transaction continuity and saving thousands in potential compliance data-exposure penalties.